complete revision of the entire legislation and personnel appointments done during the two years of Mr Janša's government. The very legitimacy of that government was put under question and its policies labelled not only as populist, but often also as Fascist.

To summarise, the far greater impact of populism in Central Europe (compared to Western Europe) 'can thus be generally explained with the help of three constitutive variables of a constitutional democracy: institutionalisation; civic awareness and active citizenship; and finally economic pluralism'. Due to a historically shorter and/or weaker record in all these three areas, Central and Eastern Europe was hit harder when it comes to 'destabilisation of constitutional democracy'. This explains why 'Western European countries, even when some of them, such as Greece, Portugal and even Ireland, suffered severely from the global financial crisis, have not upended their constitutional democracies to the same extent as has been happening in Hungary or Poland',[198] or, as Avbelj and Letnar Černič suggest in Slovenia, where wide popular support is claimed by leftist political forces.

The two Slovenian authors are also repeatedly critical of foreign observers, even international NGOs: 'Overall, one can discern heterogeneity in the pronouncements of the various regional and international human rights bodies as to human rights crises in Slovenia. The majority of these bodies have too often only pinpointed recurring themes always highlighted by ministries and publicly funded NGOs. For those reasons, some of them have turned a blind eye to practices affecting fundamental human rights issues such as the right to fair, independent and impartial trial, protection of human dignity against the abuses of state authorities, and the lack of transitional justice measures. […] This unequal approach has contributed to the creation of a public image that only certain human rights issues are of concern in Slovenia. […] Such a selective approach has certainly been politically biased, unequal and inefficient.'[199] In other words, attention to the shortcomings in the area of the rule of law can be – and sometimes apparently is – also partisan and biased. As we know from the infamous stories of the Central European University in Budapest and Soros-affiliated NGOs, Orbán pushed the issue of NGOs to the limits and exploited it for his attack on Soros and the opposition. But is it possible after all, and politically correct, to ask a question about the legitimacy and